

EDUCACIÓN
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Decision-Making and Strategic Communication in Health

- Communication Skills, Listening and Nonverbal Communication
- Health Psychology
- The Healthcare Communication Process

1. Definition of Communication Skills

Effective communication is the ability to convey information clearly and efficiently.

Communication skills allow us to express our ideas and receive those of others so that both parties clearly understand the message.

Key Elements of Effective Communication

- Clarity
- Concise
- Inquisitive
- Correct
- Complete
- Empathetic
- Concrete
- Coherence



Importance of Communication in Health Management



Effective communication in health management is crucial. It enables better coordination between teams, improves relationships with patients and increases operational efficiency. Poor communication can lead to medical errors, patient dissatisfaction and coordination problems.

Active Listening

Active listening is a fundamental part of effective communication. Listening actively means paying full attention and showing genuine interest in what the other person is saying.

This not only improves our understanding of the message, but also strengthens our interpersonal relationships.

Active listening involves listening not only to the words, but also to the speaker's tone, emotion and body language.



Active Listening Techniques



- Paraphrasing: Repeating what the other person has said in our own words to confirm our understanding.
- Asking open-ended questions: Encouraging the conversation to go deeper.
- Showing nonverbal cues: Nodding, maintaining eye contact.
- Avoiding interruptions: Letting the other person finish their ideas.
- These techniques help us show that we are paying attention and allow us to better grasp the other person's message.

Benefits of Active Listening

- Improves understanding and retention of information
- Strengthens interpersonal relationships
- Fosters an environment of respect and trust.
- In health management, active listening can improve communication with patients and among members of the healthcare team, leading to better health outcomes.



Nonverbal Communication

1. Nonverbal communication is the transmission of messages without the use of words. It includes gestures, facial expressions, posture, eye contact and proxemics, which is the use of personal space and distance.

2. Nonverbal communication can complement, emphasize or even replace verbal communication, and it is a crucial part of effective communication.



Components of Nonverbal Communication



1. **Gestures:** Hand and arm movements that can emphasize or replace words.
2. **Facial expressions:** Reflect our emotions and can influence how our message is perceived.
3. **Posture:** The way we position ourselves can convey attitudes and emotions.
4. **Eye contact:** Maintaining or avoiding eye contact can affect perceptions of trust and sincerity.
5. **Proxemics:** The use of personal space and distance can influence comfort and receptiveness to the message.

Importance of Nonverbal Communication

1. Nonverbal communication is essential because it complements and reinforces our verbal message.
2. Inconsistent nonverbal communication can lead to misunderstandings and confusion.

Example: If we say we are open to ideas, but cross our arms and avoid eye contact, the nonverbal message can contradict our words.



Examples of Nonverbal Communication in Health Management

- Affirmation gestures: Nodding to show agreement or understanding.
- Eye contact: Maintaining eye contact to show interest and attention.



Categories of Gestures

•**Adaptor gestures:** They are the **least** effective gestures in communication. They tend to convey an image of **insecurity** inconsistent with the **composure** desirable in a **leader**. Their impact on the audience's **unconscious** mind is considerable, because the **limbic system** of our brain is genetically programmed to automatically process this type of nonverbal behavior.

Adaptor Gestures

•**Nail biting** is perhaps one of the most **popular** and easily **recognizable** adaptors, but the variety is almost endless: **scratching**, **touching**, **rubbing**, **fiddling with**, **squeezing** or **manipulating** in any way any part of the **body** or an **object**: these are adaptor gestures that usually express **nervousness, anxiety** and **insecurity**.



Relaxation Gestures





- Relaxation gestures appear mainly in an environment of **intimacy** or when we believe no one is watching us. In this case, the gestures are usually linked to certain **physiological needs**, such as **tiredness**

Watch What We Touch

•Adaptor gestures that involve the **sensory organs** tend to be very revealing. Just as young children do spontaneously, covering the **mouth**, **nose**, **eyes** or **ears** can unconsciously express **discomfort** or **rejection** toward a stimulus processed by that sensory **channel**, even when done very subtly.



Pressed Lips



•**Pressed lips** can also speak, as Donald Trump has accustomed us to.

•This way of **pressing** and **thinning** the lips, so characteristic of him, is not only a **facial expression**, but at the same time an **adaptor gesture** linked to **emotional repression**, and to the attempt to hide a **basic emotion** with negative valence, such as **anger**.

• Curiously, **Donald Trump** has internalized this gesture so deeply that it appears systematically even when he tries to put on a **social smile**.

Examples











Integration of Communication Skills

- Applying these skills in team meetings, patient interactions, conflict management and communication with other organizations and stakeholders is essential.
- Let us always remember that good communication not only conveys information, but also builds relationships and facilitates collaboration

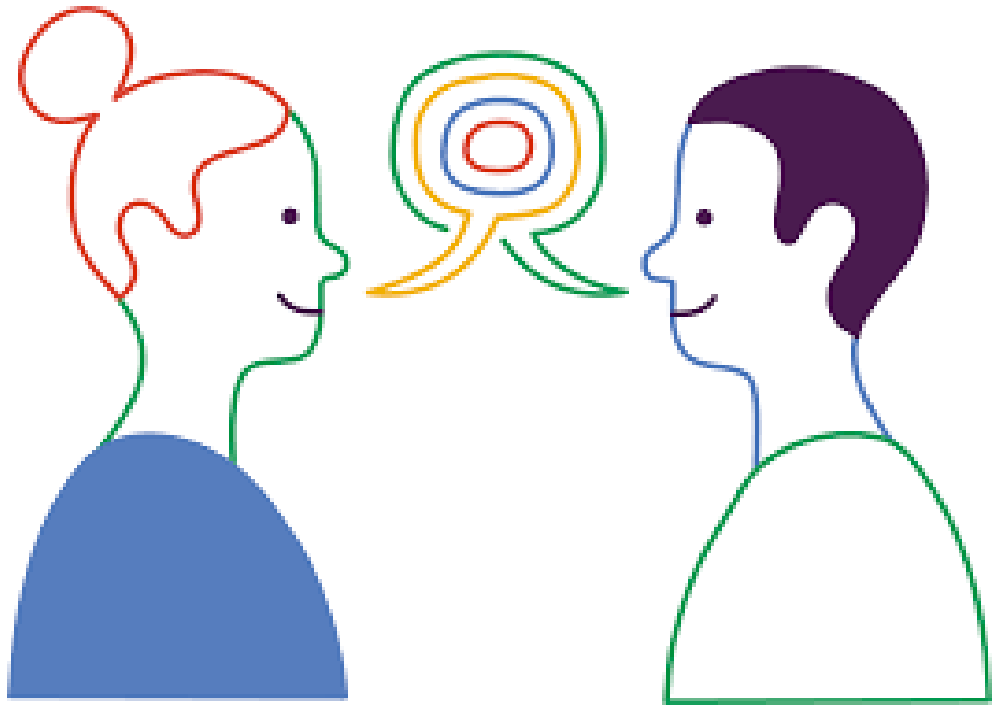


Strategies to Improve Communication



- **Continuous training:** Taking part in communication courses and workshops.
- **Regular practice:** Practicing communication and active listening techniques in daily life.
- **Feedback:** Requesting and offering feedback to improve our skills.
- **Self-assessment:** Reflecting on our interactions and looking for areas for improvement.

Impact of Effective Communication in Health Management



- **Improved quality of service:** Clear and effective communication can reduce errors and improve patient care.
- **Increased patient satisfaction:** Patients feel more valued and understood when communicated with effectively.
- **Operational efficiency:** Good communication facilitates coordination and collaboration among team members, improving operational efficiency.

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